

Streaming video evolves with AI

The biggest shift shaping 2026 is the arrival of AI-native streaming – a world where the platform is no longer a passive distributor of video, but an intelligent system that continuously learns, predicts, and adapts to every viewer in real time. At JioHotstar's scale of more than 400 million active users, this evolution is not optional; it is the only viable way



to deliver a consistent, high-quality experience to a country as diverse and complex as India. AI also enables creators to achieve scale and speed that would have been prohibitively expensive even a few years ago. This marks the beginning of AI entering the core creative process, not as a replacement for storytellers, but as an accelerator of imagination like never seen before.

—BHARATH RAM, CHIEF PRODUCT OFFICER, JIOSTAR

AI-defined telecom era

There will be no mass market personal AI without 5G. The single biggest defining telecom-tech trend for 2026 will be the emergence of AI-native, programmable, intent-driven networks. AI in networks will help service providers move to a new operation paradigm with autonomous networks to reduce TCO and enhance network reliability. With networks getting denser, with more devices, and booming traffic, it's clear: AI is our best shot at handling the complexity and keep everything running smoothly, and foundation for India's next wave of digital innovation.

—NITIN BANSAL, MANAGING DIRECTOR, INDIA, ERICSSON



Voice to multi-modal AI

Voice has already become the most intuitive interface for human computer interaction. In 2026, the most defining shift in technology will be the move from standalone voice synthesis toward fully conversational AI agents that blend high-fidelity speech with understanding, reasoning, and action across formats. Over the past year, it's become clear that voice models are converging in quality far faster than anyone expected - which is why the real differentiator ahead won't be the models themselves, but the ability to enable seamless creation and seamless interaction around them.

—CARLES REINA, GTM, ELEVENLABS



AI agent as next coworker

By 2026, AI agents will be integral members of the workforce, and managing them will feel more like mentorship than programming. We will onboard AI agents just like new human employees: by giving them access to contextual documents, letting them observe our workflows, assigning them small tasks, and providing continuous feedback to help them



learn and grow. This will extend to the full employee lifecycle, including performance reviews and even "promotions" where agents are granted more autonomy and responsibility as they prove their reliability. We will even see senior manager agents emerge that govern and validate the work of other agents: creating a dynamic, self-improving AI workforce that learns and evolves right alongside humans.

—BARIS GULTEKIN, VP OF AI, SNOWFLAKE